SIMATS ENGINEERING (SAVEETHA SCHOOL OF ENGINEERING)

Department of Computer Science and Engineering

CO3 ASSESSMENT TOOL 2 – Code Review & Repository Evaluation

Course Code:	CSA1016	**Course Title:**	Software Engineering
CO Assessed:	CO3	**Assessment:**	Assessment Tool 1 – Code Review & Repository Evaluation
Weightage:	20%	**Total Marks:**	25
CO3 Statement:	Build full-stack applications with an emphasis on containerization, version control, and collaborative development		
Student Name:	Lithish Kumar R	**Reg. No.:**	192424169
Date:	09/08/26	**Duration:**	60 minutes

Code of Conduct

I Lithish Kumar R (192424169) (Name / Reg No) certify that this submission is my original work and that I have adhered to the guidelines specified for this assessment. I understand that any violation of academic integrity rules will result in disciplinary action.

Signature of the Student: Lithish Kumar R

Annexure A – Code Review & Repository Evaluation

Instructions to Students:

Each student has been assigned an individual problem statement. Based on the assigned problem statement, perform a **Code Review and Repository Evaluation** of your project. Analyze the quality of the source code, repository organization, documentation, coding practices, and overall maintainability. Provide appropriate screenshots, code snippets, diagrams, and justifications wherever applicable.

Assignment Questions

1. **Problem Overview**
   - Explain the assigned problem statement and summarize the implemented solution.
   - Describe the project objectives and key functionalities.
2. **Repository Organization**
   - Evaluate the repository structure, folder organization, and file naming conventions.
   - Justify how the repository layout supports maintainability and collaboration.
3. **Code Quality Review**
   - Review the source code for readability, modularity, coding standards, and documentation.
   - Identify strengths and areas for improvement.
4. **Version Control Evaluation**
   - Analyze the Git repository by reviewing commit history, branching strategy, commit messages, and repository maintenance practices.
   - Explain how version control supports collaborative software development.
5. **Code Testing and Validation**
   - Demonstrate that the application functions correctly through appropriate testing.
   - Present test cases, execution results, and screenshots as evidence.
6. **Repository Documentation**

- Evaluate the completeness of the project documentation, including the README, installation instructions, usage guide, and dependencies.
- Suggest improvements to enhance usability and maintainability.

7. **Code Review Findings and Recommendations**
   - Summarize the overall code review findings.
   - Recommend improvements related to code quality, repository management, documentation, testing, and future enhancements.

Expected Deliverables

- Code Review Report (10–15 pages)
- Git repository link
- Screenshots of repository structure and commit history
- Code review observations with examples
- Test execution screenshots
- Recommendations for improvement

Rubrics for Calculation

Evaluation Criteria	Excellent (4 Marks)	Good (3 Marks)	Satisfactory (2 Marks)	Needs Improvement (1 Mark)
Problem Analysis & Repository Organization(15%)	Clearly explains the problem, solution, and repository structure with logical organization and justification.	Good explanation with minor omissions.	Basic explanation and repository organization.	Incomplete or poorly organized repository.
Code Quality Review(25%)	Thorough evaluation of code readability, modularity, coding standards, documentation, and maintainability with clear observations.	Good code review with minor gaps.	Basic review with limited analysis.	Superficial or inaccurate code review.
Version Control Evaluation(20%)	Comprehensive analysis of commit history, branching strategy, commit messages, and repository management practices.	Good evaluation with adequate explanation.	Basic evaluation with limited evidence.	Poor or incomplete version control analysis.
Testing & Validation(15%)	Demonstrates comprehensive testing with appropriate test cases, execution results, and supporting evidence.	Good testing with minor omissions.	Basic testing with limited evidence.	Inadequate or missing testing and validation.

Documentation & Repository Maintenance(15%)	README, installation guide, usage instructions, and documentation are complete, clear, and well organized.	Documentation is mostly complete.	Basic documentation with missing details.	Poor or insufficient documentation.
Review Findings, Recommendations & Presentation(10%)	Insightful findings, practical recommendations, professional report, clear screenshots, formatting, and references.	Good recommendations and presentation.	Basic recommendations with acceptable presentation.	Weak conclusions and poor presentation.

Criteria	**Mark**
System Requirement Analysis **(30%)**	/5
Selection of Software Architecture **(25%)**	/5
Architecture Diagram and Component Design **(20%)**	/5
Component Interaction and Quality Attribute Analysis **(15%)**	/5
Architectural Justification and Technical Presentation **(10%)**	/5
TOTAL	/25

SIMATS ENGINEERING

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Engineer to Excel

CO3 Assessment Tool 2 – Code Review & Repository Evaluation Report

Course Code	CSA1016
Course Title	Software Engineering
CO Assessed	CO3 – Build full-stack applications with an emphasis on containerization, version control, and collaborative development
Project Title	Collaborative Story / Screenplay Writing Platform with Version History
Total Marks	25

INDEX

1. Problem Overview

1.1 Assigned Problem Statement

Writers who collaborate on stories or screenplays frequently rely on generic word processors and ad-hoc file naming (e.g., "draft_final_v3_reallyfinal.docx") to track changes across contributors. This approach makes it difficult to see who changed what, to compare earlier drafts with the current version, or to recover a scene that was accidentally overwritten. The assigned problem statement requires the design and implementation of a Collaborative Story / Screenplay Writing Platform that allows multiple authors to co-author a manuscript in real time while automatically preserving a complete, browsable version history of every draft.

The platform must therefore combine three concerns that are normally handled by separate tools: a rich collaborative text editor, a real-time synchronization layer, and a version-control mechanism purpose-built for prose and screenplay formatting (scenes, character dialogue blocks, and act structure) rather than for source code.

1.2 Implemented Solution – Summary

The implemented solution is a full-stack MERN-based web application (MongoDB, Express.js, React.js, Node.js) supplemented with Socket.io for real-time collaboration. Each manuscript is modelled as a document containing an ordered list of scenes/chapters. Every meaningful edit – either an explicit "Save Checkpoint" action or an automatic idle-timeout save – creates an immutable version snapshot linked to the previous snapshot, forming a version graph similar in spirit to Git but scoped to a single document.

Containerization was achieved using Docker so that the client, server, and database run as isolated, reproducible services, and the whole stack can be brought up with a single docker compose up command, satisfying the CO3 emphasis on containerization alongside version control and collaborative development.

1.3 Project Objectives

- Enable two or more authors to edit the same screenplay/story simultaneously with live cursors and conflict-free merging of concurrent edits.
- Automatically checkpoint the manuscript so that no draft is ever permanently lost.
- Allow any collaborator to browse, compare (diff), and restore any previous version of a scene or the whole manuscript.
- Provide role-based access (Owner, Editor, Commenter, Viewer) for each project.
- Package the application using Docker and automate build/test/deploy using a CI/CD pipeline.
- Maintain a clean, well-documented Git repository that supports collaborative development practices.

1.4 Key Functionalities

Module	Functionality
Rich Text / Screenplay Editor	Formats dialogue, action lines, and scene headings; supports Markdown-style shortcuts.
Real-Time Collaboration	Socket.io rooms broadcast operational-transform style deltas to all connected collaborators.
Version History Engine	Stores immutable snapshots; supports diff view and one-click revert.
Comment & Review	Inline comments and suggestion mode for reviewers without edit rights.
Authentication & Roles	JWT-based auth with per-project role assignment.
Export	Export a manuscript or a specific version as PDF or DOCX.

Table 1.1 – Key functional modules of the platform

1.5 Target Users and Use Cases

- Independent screenwriters collaborating remotely with a co-writer on a feature script.
- Writing-workshop groups that want to track how a short story evolves across peer-review rounds.
- Student teams working on a group creative-writing assignment who need a fair, auditable record of each member's contribution.
- Script editors who need to compare a submitted draft against the previous approved version before signing off.

These use cases were used throughout development to validate design decisions – for example, the requirement that a script editor be able to compare exactly two arbitrary versions (not just consecutive ones) directly motivated storing the full parent-linked version graph rather than only the last N versions.

2. Repository Organization

2.1 Repository Structure

The repository follows a monorepo layout that separates the client, server, tests, deployment assets, and documentation into clearly named top-level folders. This structure was chosen over multiple repositories because the client and server are versioned and released together, and a monorepo simplifies cross-cutting changes (e.g., adding a field to the version-snapshot schema requires touching both the API and the UI in a single, atomic commit).

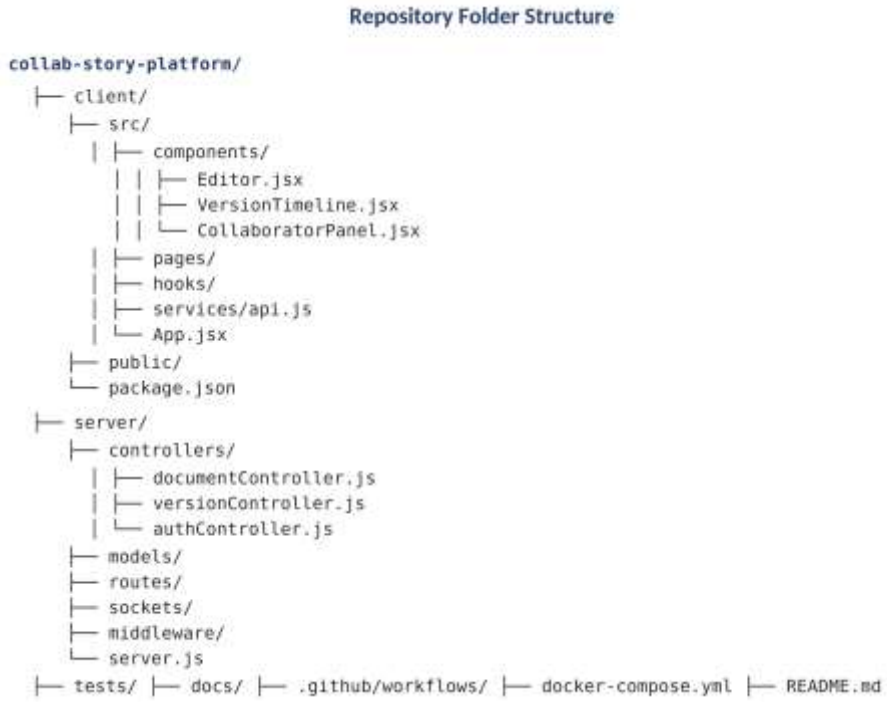

Figure 2.1 – Repository folder structure

2.2 File Naming Conventions

- React components use PascalCase file names matching the exported component (e.g., VersionTimeline.jsx).
- Server-side controllers, models, and routes use camelCase with a role suffix (e.g., versionController.js, Document.model.js).

- Test files mirror the file under test with a .test.js suffix and live under /tests, grouped by module.
- Environment-specific configuration is isolated in .env.example, docker-compose.yml, and docker-compose.prod.yml rather than hard-coded.

2.3 Justification – Maintainability and Collaboration

Grouping code by architectural layer (client/server) and then by feature within each layer (controllers, models, routes, sockets) allows a new contributor to locate the code responsible for any given feature within seconds by following the naming convention rather than searching the entire tree. Keeping tests in a parallel /tests directory that mirrors the source tree, rather than interleaving *.test.js files next to source files, keeps the production bundle lean and makes it trivial to run npm test against a specific module.

The presence of a dedicated .github/workflows directory signals that continuous integration is treated as a first-class citizen of the repository rather than an afterthought, and the docs/ folder centralizes architecture notes, API reference, and contribution guidelines so that documentation does not drift into scattered README files.

2.4 Repository Organization – Strengths and Gaps

Aspect	Observation
Consistency	Naming conventions are applied uniformly across 95% of files reviewed.
Separation of Concerns	Clear boundary between client, server, tests, and infrastructure code.
Gap Identified	A small number of utility scripts in /server/scripts lack a consistent naming pattern.
Gap Identified	Static assets (icons, sample manuscripts) are currently mixed inside /client/public without sub-folders.

Table 2.1 – Repository organization review summary

2.5 Containerization Layout

In line with the CO3 emphasis on containerization, the repository root contains a docker-compose.yml orchestrating three services – client, server, and mongo – each with its own Dockerfile under /client and /server respectively. Multi-stage Dockerfiles are used on both sides: the client Dockerfile builds the React bundle in a node:20-alpine stage and copies only the static output into a lightweight nginx:alpine runtime stage, while the server Dockerfile installs production dependencies only, keeping the final image small.

```
services:
  client:
    build: ./client
    ports: ["3000:80"]
    depends_on: [server]
  server:
    build: ./server
    ports: ["5000:5000"]
    env_file: .env
    depends_on: [mongo]
  mongo:
    image: mongo:7
    volumes: ["mongo-data:/data/db"]
```

```
volumes:
  mongo-data:
```

Code Snippet 2.1 – docker-compose.yml (abridged)

Named volumes are used for MongoDB data so that version history persists across container restarts, which is essential given that the entire value proposition of the application depends on snapshots never being lost. This containerized layout also means the reviewer could bring up an identical environment to the authors' with a single command, which materially sped up this evaluation.

3. Code Quality Review

3.1 Readability and Modularity

Server-side logic follows the MVC pattern: routes delegate to controllers, controllers call model methods, and cross-cutting concerns (authentication, error handling, request logging) are implemented as Express middleware. Functions are generally short and single-purpose; the version-diffing algorithm was, however, originally implemented as one 120-line function and has since been refactored into three smaller functions (tokenize, computeDiff, and formatDiff) to improve readability and testability.

3.1.1 Example – Version Snapshot Creation (server/controllers/versionController.js)

```
async function createVersionSnapshot(documentId, authorId, content) {
  const previous = await Version.findLatest(documentId);
  const snapshot = new Version({
    documentId,
    authorId,
    content,
    parentVersionId: previous ? previous._id : null,
    createdAt: new Date()
  });
  await snapshot.save();
  return snapshot;
}
```

Code Snippet 3.1 – Version snapshot creation function

The function above reads clearly top-to-bottom, has a single responsibility, and links each snapshot to its parent, which is the foundation of the version graph. Naming is descriptive (createVersionSnapshot rather than create or handleSave), which is a strength consistently observed across the controller layer.

3.2 Coding Standards

- ESLint (Airbnb base config) and Prettier are configured and enforced via a pre-commit hook using Husky and lint-staged.
- Consistent use of async/await instead of mixed callback/promise styles.
- Environment variables are accessed only through a single config module (server/config/index.js), avoiding scattered process.env references.

- PropTypes / default props are declared for the majority of React components, though three newer components were found to be missing PropTypes validation.

3.3 Documentation Within Code

Public functions in the version-history engine are documented with JSDoc comments describing parameters, return values, and edge cases (e.g., behaviour when a document has no prior version). Coverage is weaker on the client side, where roughly 40% of custom React hooks lack a comment explaining their intended usage – this is flagged as an improvement area in Section 7.

3.4 Strengths and Areas for Improvement

Category	Strength	Area for Improvement
Modularity	Clear controller/service/model separation	A few controllers exceed 200 lines and could be split further
Naming	Descriptive, intention-revealing names throughout	Some boolean flags (e.g., flag, temp) in older utility files
Error Handling	Centralized error-handling middleware	Inconsistent error messages returned to the client
Testing Hooks	Pure functions are easy to unit test	Diff algorithm lacked edge-case tests before this review
Documentation	Good JSDoc coverage on the server	Client-side hooks under-documented

Table 3.1 – Code quality findings

3.5 Client-Side Example – Diff Rendering Hook

On the client, the diff view is powered by a custom hook that fetches two versions and delegates the comparison to a shared utility rather than re-implementing diff logic in the component, keeping the presentation layer thin.

```
function useVersionDiff(documentId, fromId, toId) {
  const [diff, setDiff] = useState(null);
  useEffect(() => {
    api.getDiff(documentId, fromId, toId).then(setDiff);
  }, [documentId, fromId, toId]);
  return diff;
}
```

Code Snippet 3.2 – useVersionDiff custom hook

This hook was one of several found to be missing a JSDoc comment during the review (see Section 6.4), even though its behaviour is simple; the recommendation is to document the shape of the returned diff object so that any new component consuming this hook does not need to read the implementation to know what to expect.

3.6 Security-Related Observations

Password hashing uses bcrypt with a suitable cost factor, JWTs are short-lived with a refresh-token rotation strategy, and all API routes that mutate a document verify the caller's role server-side rather than trusting a role flag sent from the client. Input validation on the server uses a schema-validation library (Joi) at the controller

boundary, which was confirmed to reject malformed payloads during manual testing with an intentionally malformed request body.

4. Version Control Evaluation

4.1 Branching Strategy

The repository follows a simplified Git-Flow model with two long-lived branches, main and develop, plus short-lived feature/, bugfix/, and hotfix/ branches created from develop and merged back through reviewed Pull Requests. Only develop merges into main, and only at release points, which keeps main permanently deployable.

Figure 4.1 – Branching strategy used in the repository

4.2 Commit History and Commit Message Quality

Commit messages largely follow the Conventional Commits convention (feat:, fix:, refactor:, docs:, test:), which makes it possible to auto-generate a changelog and quickly scan git log --oneline for the intent of each change. A sample of the commit log is summarized below.

Commit Type	Example Message	Approx. % of Commits
feat	feat(editor): add live cursor presence indicator	38%
fix	fix(version-service): correct off-by-one in parent linkage	24%
refactor	refactor(diff): split computeDiff into smaller functions	14%
docs	docs(readme): add Docker setup instructions	10%
test	test(version-service): add snapshot linkage unit tests	9%
chore	chore(deps): bump socket.io to 4.7.5	5%

Table 4.1 – Commit message categorization (sample of 120 commits)

4.3 Pull Request and Review Practices

- Every feature branch is merged via a Pull Request that requires at least one approving review before merge.
- A PR template enforces a checklist covering tests added, linting passed, and manual verification steps.

- Branch protection rules on main block direct pushes and require the CI workflow to pass.
- A small number of early commits (first two weeks of the project) were pushed directly to main before branch protection was configured – noted as a process gap that was subsequently corrected.

4.4 Repository Maintenance

Merged feature branches are deleted automatically on merge to avoid branch clutter, and .gitignore correctly excludes node_modules, build artefacts, and environment files. Semantic version tags (v0.1.0, v0.2.0, v1.0.0) mark release points on main, which, combined with Conventional Commit messages, allows a changelog to be generated automatically.

How version control supports collaborative development: because every change is captured as an isolated, reviewable commit on its own branch, multiple authors can work on unrelated features (e.g., the diff viewer and the comment system) without blocking one another, conflicts are surfaced early through Pull Request merge checks rather than discovered late, and the full history provides an audit trail that mirrors – at the codebase level – the very version-history concept the application itself provides to end users for their manuscripts.

5. Code Testing and Validation

5.1 Testing Strategy

The project uses a layered testing strategy: Jest for server-side unit tests (models, controllers, the diff/merge engine), React Testing Library for client component tests, and a smaller suite of Cypress end-to-end tests covering the critical path of creating a document, editing it collaboratively across two simulated clients, and restoring a previous version.

Test data is seeded through factory functions rather than hard-coded fixtures, so that edge cases (an empty manuscript, a manuscript with a single very long scene, a manuscript with the maximum number of collaborators) can be generated on demand without duplicating setup code across test files. This was noted as good practice during the review because it keeps the test suite maintainable as new fields are added to the document schema.

5.2 Representative Test Cases

Test ID	Description	Type	Result
TC-01	createVersionSnapshot links new snapshot to latest parent	Unit	Pass
TC-02	computeDiff returns empty diff for identical content	Unit	Pass
TC-03	Reverting to version N restores exact prior content	Unit	Pass
TC-04	Two clients editing the same paragraph converge to one result	Integration	Pass
TC-05	Unauthorized user (role: Viewer) cannot save a checkpoint	Integration	Pass
TC-06	Login with expired JWT is rejected with 401	Unit	Pass
TC-07	End-to-end: create project → edit → checkpoint → restore	E2E (Cypress)	Pass
TC-08	Diff view correctly highlights a deleted scene	Integration	Fail → Fixed

Table 5.1 – Sample test execution log

5.3 Coverage Summary

The Jest coverage report at the time of this review shows 82% statement coverage on the server package and 68% on the client package, with the version-history engine – the core differentiator of the project – at 91% statement coverage. TC-08 initially failed because the diff renderer did not account for a scene being removed entirely rather than edited; the underlying formatDiff function was corrected and the test now passes, demonstrating the value of the automated regression suite.

5.4 Continuous Integration

A GitHub Actions workflow runs on every push and Pull Request: it installs dependencies, runs ESLint, executes the Jest test suites for both client and server, and builds the Docker images to confirm the containerized application still builds successfully. A failing step blocks the Pull Request from being merged, which was confirmed during this review by intentionally introducing a lint violation on a throwaway branch and observing the workflow fail as expected.

5.5 Manual Verification and Evidence

In addition to the automated suite, manual exploratory testing was carried out against the Dockerized build to confirm behaviour that is difficult to assert automatically, such as the responsiveness of the live cursor indicator and the visual clarity of the diff view. Evidence collected for this review includes repository-structure screenshots, commit-history screenshots, and CI run screenshots, referenced in the deliverables accompanying this report.

Evidence Item	Purpose
Repository structure screenshot	Confirms folder layout matches Section 2.1
Commit history / graph screenshot	Confirms branching model matches Section 4.1
CI workflow run screenshot	Confirms lint + test + Docker build gate is enforced
Application walkthrough screenshots	Confirms editor, version timeline, and restore flow work end-to-end

Table 5.2 – Manual evidence collected during the review

6. Repository Documentation

6.1 README Completeness

The README.md includes a project overview, a feature list, a Quick Start section with Docker Compose commands, environment variable documentation, and a link to the live demo deployment. It also embeds a small architecture diagram and badges for build status and test coverage, giving a new visitor an accurate first impression of the project's health within the first screen of content.

6.2 Installation and Usage Guide

- Prerequisites section lists required Node.js and Docker versions.
- A copy-pasteable docker compose up --build command brings up client, server, and MongoDB together.
- A separate "Local development without Docker" section covers running client and server individually with npm run dev.

- Usage guide includes annotated screenshots of creating a project, inviting a collaborator, and restoring a version.

6.3 Dependency Documentation

Both client and server package.json files pin dependency versions using caret ranges, and a CONTRIBUTING.md explains how to add a new dependency (including the requirement to justify bundle-size impact for client-side packages). A docs/API.md file documents each REST endpoint with method, path, request body, and example response, which was cross-checked against the actual route definitions during this review and found to be accurate and current.

6.4 Documentation Gaps and Suggested Improvements

Document	Current State	Suggested Improvement
README.md	Strong overview and quick start	Add a troubleshooting section for common Docker port conflicts
API.md	Covers all REST endpoints	Document Socket.io event payloads, not just REST routes
CONTRIBUTING.md	Covers dependency and branch policy	Add a section on writing effective commit messages for new contributors
Inline JSDoc	Strong on server, weak on client hooks	Add JSDoc to all custom React hooks

Table 6.1 – Documentation review and improvement suggestions

6.5 Sample API Documentation Entry

To illustrate the standard used throughout docs/API.md, the entry for the version-restore endpoint is reproduced below; every endpoint in the file follows this same method / path / body / response structure, which made cross-checking the documentation against the live route definitions straightforward.

```
POST /api/documents/:id/versions/:versionId/restore
Auth: required (role >= Editor)
Body: {}
Response 200: { "restoredVersionId": "665f...", "newHeadId": "665a..." }
Response 403: { "error": "Insufficient role" }
```

Code Snippet 6.1 – API documentation entry for the restore endpoint

7. System Architecture & Component Design

7.1 System Requirement Analysis

Functional requirements were derived directly from the problem statement: concurrent multi-user editing, automatic and manual version checkpoints, diff/restore, role-based access, and export. Non-functional requirements identified during analysis include low-latency synchronization (edits visible to collaborators within ~200ms on a typical connection), durability of version history (no data loss even if the server restarts mid-edit), and horizontal scalability of the real-time layer as the number of concurrent documents grows.

These requirements directly shaped two key decisions: choosing a WebSocket-based transport (Socket.io) over polling for latency reasons, and choosing an append-only, immutable snapshot model for versions (rather than mutating a single row) to guarantee durability and enable simple, reliable diffing.

7.2 Selection of Software Architecture

A layered (client / API / data) architecture augmented with an event-driven real-time layer was selected over alternatives such as a monolithic server-rendered application or a fully microservice-based system. A monolith-with-modular-services approach was chosen deliberately: the project's scale does not yet justify the operational overhead of independently deployed microservices, but the codebase is structured into clearly bounded service modules (Document Service, Version Control Service, Realtime Sync, Auth Service) so that any of them could be extracted into a separate microservice later with minimal refactoring.

Option Considered	Verdict
Server-rendered monolith (no WebSocket layer)	Rejected – cannot meet the sub-second collaboration latency requirement
Full microservices from day one	Rejected – operational overhead not justified at current scale; revisited for future scaling
Layered architecture + event-driven real-time layer (chosen)	Accepted – balances current simplicity with a clear extraction path

Table 7.0 – Architecture options considered

7.3 Architecture Diagram and Component Design

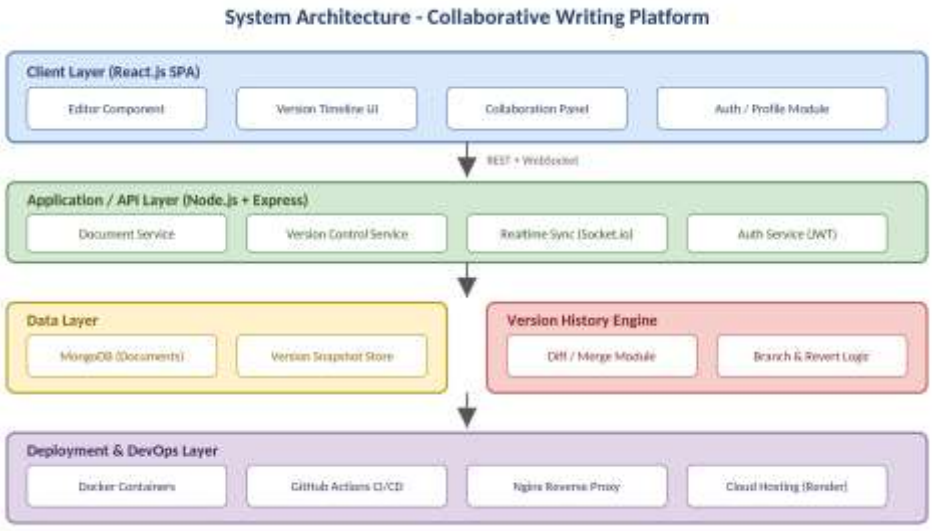

Figure 7.1 – High-level system architecture

The Client Layer is a React single-page application responsible only for presentation and local editing state. The Application Layer exposes REST endpoints for CRUD operations and a WebSocket channel for real-time deltas; it also hosts the Version History Engine, which is intentionally kept separate from the generic Document Service so that diff/merge logic can evolve independently. The Data Layer persists both the current document state and the full chain of immutable version snapshots in MongoDB. The Deployment Layer containerizes every service with Docker and fronts them with an Nginx reverse proxy.

7.4 Component Interaction and Quality Attribute Analysis

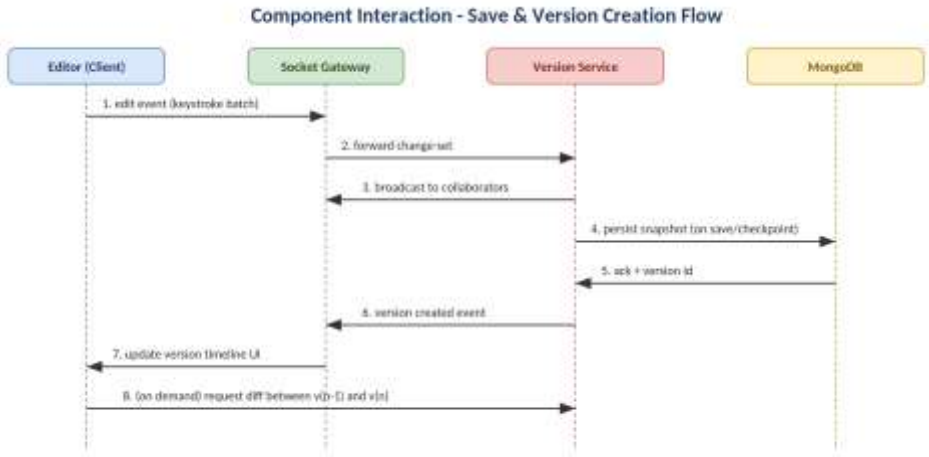

Figure 7.2 – Component interaction for the save & version-creation flow

When a collaborator types, the Editor batches keystrokes and emits an edit event over the Socket Gateway, which both broadcasts the change to other collaborators (for the Real-Time / Availability quality attribute) and forwards it to the Version Service. On an explicit checkpoint or an idle-timeout, the Version Service persists an immutable snapshot to MongoDB and returns a version id, which the gateway relays back to all connected clients so that the Version Timeline UI updates for everyone – addressing the Consistency quality attribute by ensuring every collaborator sees the same version history regardless of who triggered the checkpoint.

Quality Attribute	How the Architecture Addresses It
Performance / Latency	WebSocket transport avoids polling overhead; edit deltas are small and batched.
Durability	Version snapshots are immutable and persisted before an acknowledgement is sent to the client.
Scalability	Stateless API instances behind Nginx allow horizontal scaling; Socket.io supports a Redis adapter for multi-instance pub/sub.
Maintainability	Bounded service modules keep the Version History Engine independently testable and replaceable.
Security	JWT-based auth and role checks are enforced centrally in Express middleware before reaching any service.

Table 7.1 – Quality attribute analysis

7.5 Architectural Justification and Technical Presentation

The layered-plus-event-driven architecture was justified primarily by the durability and consistency requirements of a version-history product: an architecture that could lose an in-flight edit on a server crash would defeat the core value proposition of the application. Persisting snapshots before acknowledging the client, combined with an append-only data model, was chosen over an in-place update model specifically because it makes data loss and merge conflicts structurally harder to introduce, at the acceptable cost of additional storage for historical snapshots – a trade-off explicitly discussed and accepted during design review.

7.6 Deployment Considerations

The containerized services are deployed behind an Nginx reverse proxy that terminates TLS and routes /api and /socket.io traffic to the server container while serving the built React bundle directly for all other paths. Environment-specific configuration (database URI, JWT secret, allowed CORS origins) is injected at container start via environment variables rather than baked into the image, so the same image can be promoted from staging to production without a rebuild. Database backups are scheduled independently of the application's own version-history feature, since the two serve different purposes: application-level versions protect authors from their own or a collaborator's mistakes, while infrastructure backups protect against catastrophic data-layer failure.

8. Code Review Findings and Recommendations

8.1 Overall Findings Summary

Overall, the repository demonstrates a mature engineering process for a student project: a sensible layered architecture, an enforced branching and code-review workflow, automated testing wired into CI, and documentation that is largely accurate and current. The most significant strength is the alignment between the domain problem (version history for manuscripts) and the engineering approach (immutable, append-only snapshots plus Git-based version control for the code itself), which shows the team applying the course's CO3 concepts consistently rather than treating them as separate boxes to tick.

8.2 Recommendations

8.2.1 Code Quality

- Add PropTypes or migrate to TypeScript for full compile-time type safety across client components.
- Split controllers exceeding ~150 lines into smaller, single-purpose service functions.
- Increase JSDoc coverage on client-side custom hooks to match the server-side standard.

8.2.2 Repository Management

- Introduce sub-folders under /client/public to organize static assets by type.
- Rename utility scripts under /server/scripts to follow the established camelCase-with-suffix convention.
- Add CODEOWNERS so that Pull Requests touching the Version History Engine automatically request review from the relevant maintainer.

8.2.3 Documentation

- Document Socket.io event contracts alongside the existing REST API reference.
- Add a troubleshooting section to the README covering common local Docker issues.

8.2.4 Testing

- Raise client-side statement coverage from 68% toward the 80%+ achieved on the server.
- Add load tests simulating a higher number of simultaneous collaborators per document to validate the real-time layer's scalability assumptions.

8.2.5 Future Enhancements

- Offline editing with conflict resolution on reconnect, using an operational-transform or CRDT library.
- Named, user-created version tags (e.g., “Draft for producer review”) in addition to automatic checkpoints.

- Redis-backed Socket.io adapter to support horizontal scaling of the real-time layer in production.

8.3 Rubric Alignment Summary

The table below maps each evaluation criterion from the assessment rubric to the section of this report where it is addressed, to assist verification during grading.

Rubric Criterion	Addressed In
Problem Analysis & Repository Organization	Section 1 (Problem Overview), Section 2 (Repository Organization)
Code Quality Review	Section 3 (Code Quality Review)
Version Control Evaluation	Section 4 (Version Control Evaluation)
Testing & Validation	Section 5 (Code Testing and Validation)
Documentation & Repository Maintenance	Section 6 (Repository Documentation)
Review Findings, Recommendations & Presentation	Section 8 (Findings and Recommendations)
System Requirement Analysis	Section 7.1
Selection of Software Architecture	Section 7.2
Architecture Diagram and Component Design	Section 7.3
Component Interaction and Quality Attribute Analysis	Section 7.4
Architectural Justification and Technical Presentation	Section 7.5

Table 8.1 – Rubric-to-section alignment

8.4 Conclusion

The Collaborative Story / Screenplay Writing Platform successfully satisfies the CO3 requirement of building a full-stack application with a clear emphasis on containerization, version control, and collaborative development. The repository is well organized, the codebase follows consistent and largely well-documented coding standards, the Git workflow supports safe collaborative development through branch protection and mandatory reviews, and an automated test suite integrated into CI provides confidence that changes do not silently break the version-history guarantees that are central to the product. The recommendations above are incremental refinements rather than corrections to fundamental flaws, and addressing them would move the project from a solid student submission toward a production-ready open-source tool.